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Holly Hofmann

Holly Hofmann is one of the most recognizable music personalities in southern California. She performs frequently as a jazz flautist and has recorded highly acclaimed recordings for the Azica and Jazz Alliance labels. Holly has played alongside Frank Wess, Slide Hampton, and James Moody, and she employs pianist Mike Wofford in her San Diego ensemble. In addition to her performing, Holly contributes to the San Diego music scene by booking and promoting jazz talent in area venues. Her own wide-ranging musical tastes can encompass jazz, classical and contemporary popular music to create a distinct signature sound.

Holly was interviewed in San Diego, California on February 13, 1998, by Monk Rowe, Director of the Hamilton College Jazz Archive.

MR: We are filming in San Diego, California, and it's my pleasure to have jazz flautist Holly Hoffman for my guest. My name is Monk Rowe. And I'm going to see if I can imagine a little scenario here. You are a classical flute player taking years of classical lessons, and all of a sudden you get turned on to jazz. And your parents go what are you doing now? What happened to all those lessons? Is that close at all?

HH: Well it's not close only in that I started jazz first.

MR: No kidding.

HH: Dad was a jazz guitarist. So although he was just, he just did it for fun, once the kids started coming along, we played every night after dinner from age five on. And so actually my lessons started at age seven as a support to having learned standards with Dad. I could play the real easy kind of "Springtime," "Beautiful Springtime" and a lot of the simple standards that I could actually get on the instrument, because I didn't have too many notes that I could play at that point, at five. And then there was the bottom register, that I couldn't reach yet. So really, they thought there was some natural jazz ability there, and that's why they sent me for classical lessons, because my dad didn't feel like I'd have the aptitude for jazz if I didn't get the instrument accomplished. And actually at four I was playing on a little flutophone, and that's how the flute thing kind of happened. Then I got a flute at five.

MR: I think your father had some pretty far reaching thinking. To recognize —

HH: Especially for that time, and especially for a little girl, and well they both claim that I was bouncing on mother's lap on two and four, at two and a half. So that was father's indication that —

MR: That's important — she knows the back beat.

HH: Yeah. There was hope there for me to carry on the tradition.

MR: Wow. Did you get interested in classical music enough so that it became something you wanted to pursue or was it always that jazz remained the thing?

HH: I think pretty much jazz remained the thing. I was not encouraged to play jazz through really all my classical education, because I was studying with the principal flautist of the Cleveland Orchestra, Maurice Sharp, and he felt that jazz was a lesser music. And so really he was pretty rigid about it. And then when I went to, I did my undergraduate school at Cleveland Institute of Music and stayed with him for the four years, because I had an opportunity at that time to sub for him at the Cleveland Orchestra. And that really made me want to go there to school. And at that time it was really frowned on in terms of getting a conservatory education. You were not to be out playing gigs and doing anything other than the classical, and frankly I didn't have much time to pursue it during those years because school took all my attention.

MR: Is there anything in jazz that you've done as nerve wracking as playing in a symphony orchestra? That's a personal opinion.

HH: Well no, because I never had the chops as a classical flautist that I feel that I'm starting to get as a jazz musician. Chops make you — the command of the instrument and the idiom make you comfortable. And classical music seems like an endless study of styles and articulations and the proper ornamentation and all the things that you need to pursue for the rest of your life. Just like in jazz, I will need to pursue tunes and changes and styles there for the rest of my life. But I was never as natural at it as I am at jazz, at the classical.

MR: And I think in jazz you have the ability to — if there's a mistake, you can make it work in your favor, or at least you can deal with it.

HH: Yes.

MR: If you make a mistake in an orchestra—

HH: Really bad.

MR: Ooh. Or you don't come in at the right time.

HH: Yes, I've done that. Not in performance fortunately.

MR: Yeah. So you're from — where are you from? I didn't have this information.

HH: From just outside Cleveland, Ohio. And so that was how I had that association in Cleveland with Maurice Sharp. He had been the principal flautist of the Cleveland Orchestra for 44 years.

MR: Wow. Some seniority there.

HH: Yeah. He was there in the Rodzinski days and the George Szell days. That was quite a — he was quite an icon. He was a big deal to study with. And very, very strict. He was one of the last of the real task masters.

MR: I see Frank Wess show up on your list of people that you've played with and studied with? How did that come about?

HH: That came about through another wonderful jazz musician named Slide Hampton, who heard me at a Jamey Aebersold clinic when I was in college, and we struck up a friendship and a long — years later we still get a chance to play together upon occasion. And he suggested that I come to New York during the summers and study with Frank a bit, which I did several different summers in college. And that was a wonderful experience. And Frank, to this day, in fact we're going to be playing together on the West Coast Jazz Party, now getting to play as a peer with him, although I'd never in my mind be a peer of Frank Wess, but to get to play on the same stage with him, is just a fabulous thing that's happened there. And he was also a teacher that was very strict about certain things and gave me a lot of input, and probably some of the best input on the flute I've ever had. Because there were not a lot of people playing flute when I was a young girl, for me to listen to, just a very few, and he was one of the only guys.

MR: Yeah. There seems to be a — let's say historical confusion about who actually was the first, or at least flute player to appear on a jazz record. Some say it was Frank, I've heard Sam Most.

HH: I think actually it was Wayman Carver.

MR: Okay, that's another name I've heard.

HH: And really that was the first one. And shortly after that, Sam Most, Joe Farrell, Frank Wess. I'm not quite sure of the chronology there.

MR: He really gave the Basie thing another sound to work with and inspired all those cool arrangements.

HH: Oh, yeah. Those were the years of the Basie band.

MR: Yeah. Did you have occasion to hear him live a lot of times back then?

HH: Not on the Basie band, no.

MR: Yeah, that was post-Basie, right?

HH: I didn't. But yes, I've heard him live many times, and I'm just in awe of what he can do, especially considering that he still doubles to this day. And many of the flute players, including Hubert Laws, well Moody still doubles, I'm thinking Herbie Mann, a lot of those guys just don't double anymore because it's a tremendous embouchure change. And it's been really — the fact that he does it so well, it just amazes me. When I on the other hand tried to play saxophone in college, because everybody told me that I would get no gigs being just a flute player, I would have to double so I could play in big bands. And I very seriously studied the saxophone for nine months until one of the conductors one day said, "Madam assistant principal flute, I don't know what you're doing with your sound but stop it."

MR: Ooh. Ouch. Did he say this in front of the—

HH: In front of 79 other people. And I said I probably should stop it.

MR: Did he know what you were doing?

HH: No.

MR: But he knew something was going on that was effecting your sound.

HH: And I guess I kind of knew but I was kind of hoping that it would just straighten itself out.

MR: Gee. Is it the fact that your bottom lip sits on your teeth and that it just changes your muscle structure?

HH: For me I felt that the saxophone was a very tightened embouchure. I had to tighten a lot of muscles around here, and I had learned an embouchure on the flute that was very relaxed. And I couldn't make the biting kind of change there that is necessary for saxophone. So Frank has really — Frank and Moody and Buddy Colette and all the guys who still double and do it so well just amaze me.

MR: Well maybe it makes a difference if you play the saxophone first.

HH: Yeah, maybe. I had been a flute player for a lot of years when I tried.

MR: Right. What brought you to San Diego?

HH: Friends, actually not in the music field, feeling that I needed to live on one of the coasts for work, and after graduate school I was living in Denver because I went to the University of Northern Colorado for graduate. And Denver was definitely not the place. It has an emphasis on other kinds of music there. And so I felt that New York was a bit much at that point for me, so I worked in the San Diego and Los Angeles area first. And then San Diego just grew on me, and it just seemed like the right place to be.

MR: Has it worked out pretty well?

HH: Yeah. It's not a big jazz town, but I travel a lot and I manage to keep a steady gig going pretty much all them time when I'm here. I've been very fortunate. And of course I have the phenomenal rhythm section here of Mike Wofford, Bob Mangusson and Jim Plank, so I'm really spoiled.

MR: And when you say you travel, you get thrown in with other people, other rhythm sections, and like most of the people we were talking about that are here for this jazz party, a big part of — one thing that I think students need to know about being a jazz musician is a big part of it is knowing repertory. Is that something you're constantly working on?

HH: Just when I think I know a lot of tunes, I run into somebody who knows double the tunes I know. Like Mike Wofford is a good example. There's not a tune you can call out that Mike doesn't know. So yeah I'm constantly learning tunes, constantly writing, constantly rearranging old standards that are still great tunes, into maybe a little bit different groove or just a different way of playing the tune, to make it fresh.

MR: When you're with, on a festival or a party or something, you don't see too many flute players for one thing. What is the role of the flute in a throw-together ensemble? You

know like if you go down and you see a rhythm section and you have a trumpet and a sax and a trombone, you kind of know who's going to be doing something. If they call "Lady Be Good," you kind of know, and they know. Where do you fit in in that scenario?

HH: It really depends on the tune and the players I'd have to say, although I'm always kind of on the top. I'd many times be playing the melody or playing, if there's a melody instrument playing the head, like a saxophone player, I'd maybe be playing little background fills. Definitely not harmony. Usually the trombones and the trumpets and things do that.

MR: So you're almost taking the place of like the clarinet in a Dixieland band?

HH: Maybe. Yeah. You could put it that way. I try to put the flute into another position, like it's just another horn instead of being a flute. Because a lot of people still don't consider the flute necessarily a jazz instrument, or they think that a female is going to play it in some kind of feminine sense instead of a really hard-hitting jazz, aggressive jazz style. And while there's a place for that, you know on a burning tune on a jazz festival that's not one of them. So I try to really take it out of that flutistic feminine thing and put it into just another horn. And a lot of promoters say oh we can't put a flute with all these horns. I say well give me a microphone. I'll be fine. And until they actually hear it they don't see it fitting in a lot of times. So I always try and get them to hear it.

MR: Do you pretty much promote your own self? Do you have an agent?

HH: I had an agency up until this last year for several years and there were some ethical concerns there, and I went back to doing my — I let them go and I went back to doing my own booking, which is a real hard thing to do, especially during the summer months when we're all on tour. But it's actually I think worked out better because I think many of the promoters like to talk to the artists. And I can explain what it is that I do and what I need probably better than an agent can. It's very hard to find the time to do both.

MR: So, let me rewind a little bit to your childhood again, because I find it fascinating that you were jamming with your father when you were five. Did he play out? Did he play gigs and so forth?

HH: Yes he did, for a few years, early on in my life I can remember him coming home from the chemical plant that he worked in all day and going out on a gig. But then more and more he pretty much was just home with the kids.

MR: Did you trust his opinions when it came to music then?

HH: Oh well yeah, because I didn't know, I mean he sounded wonderful to me, and I listened to records and he pointed out things on the records and I always understood what he was telling me. So yes I thought he was just wonderful. I had a rude awakening I guess later on when I went to high school at the Interlochen Arts Academy, and I started to learn some lessons there and then more lessons as I went to college, about the role of women,

or should I say the lack of the role of women in jazz at that point, because Dad felt that if you played well, it didn't matter if you were male or female or black or white or what instrument you played, you just would get the gig. And I grew up with that in my mind, and then I got to a certain point where I found out that wasn't really the case. And that was real hard. It was probably the hardest thing to deal with as a young player. Because I started to realize that there were all sorts of reasons for getting gigs, and a lot of times very little of it had to do with talent.

MR: Is that still something that you feel affects how much work you get? That you're a woman?

HH: It's affecting it less and less I'm happy to say. But yes it does. And many times I'm dictated to about rhythm sections, having a certain amount of African-American players and white players, I'm still told many times that flute is not a jazz instrument, it doesn't belong on this or that. And so there's discrimination in terms of what instrument I'm playing. Sometimes, unfortunately, still, there's a group of male promoters that don't feel women swing, or really belong in the jazz idiom, and that's getting less and less but it's still there. And then there is still a strong issue in terms of the African-American community versus the white community as far as you know, who gets the gig in those circumstances too. There's a group of African-American listeners who feel that they support the African-American musicians simply because they feel it's their music.

MR: Right. Where are those kinds of things happening mostly? I'm not sure that that's a fair question. At festivals and so forth?

HH: I think less at festivals, and more in terms of the individual cities, where people who run jazz festivals are jazz societies, where they bring in bands and things. A lot of them seem to be limited in their thinking. When all kinds of people can play this music. It's nobody's music and nobody owns it. And unfortunately it's been perpetrated a bit in terms of the booking now that's going on at Lincoln Center with Wynton Marsalis, it's a very African-American music program. So that's had its effect unfortunately.

MR: Do you think it's a pendulum that will someday slow down and stop somewhere that's fair for everybody?

HH: I hope so. I don't know that I know the answer to that. They tell me that years ago a lot of the black players didn't get gigs that the white players got. Conversely there was like a reverse discrimination going on there.

MR: That the black big bands had to do a lot more one-nighters as opposed to sitting down at a hotel for a couple of —

HH: It's funny that that issue has to get into the art, isn't it?

MR: Funny is a kind word.

HH: Yeah.

MR: Yeah, it is. And most of the musicians will tell you that it's all about music. It's the promoters and so forth that I guess change the issue.

HH: Yeah.

MR: You had mentioned that you listened to records of course. Who were the people that you were listening to that put you on a path?

HH: Mostly big band players ironically. My dad a lot of big band records, and one of the first lyrical soloists that I heard that I told dad I wanted to play like was Johnny Hodges. And I picked him out. Dad would put on different records, and I would pick him out off every single kind of ballad recording, and say that's how I want my ballads to sound, Dad. Dizzy Gillespie once told me that I played like a trumpet player. And he suspected that I grew up listening to bebop trumpet players and trumpet players from big band, swing band trumpet players because my style was nothing like saxophone and nothing like any other flute. So I really did listen to a lot of trumpet players, because the primary soloist in the bands at that point were trumpet and sax. A little less with trombone but still some.

MR: And who were the first — of course Frank Wess, any other early jazz flute players effect you?

HH: The flute players not so much. People gave me a lot of Paul Horn and Herbie Mann and you know my parents' friends gave me a wealth of LPs and things. But they were never playing the flute like I heard the flute. And I mean no disrespect by that, I just heard something different. I heard I guess the flute being a horn. And in those days they were always playing the flute in that, you know, the doublers would play a real burning saxophone solo, and then pick up and only use the flute in a really pretty kind of fluffy setting. And I didn't hear it that way.

MR: So save the records and give me some clothes or something.

HH: And then I guess I started listening to the masters. Because then I started being guided by people who had a lot of knowledge of jazz, even more so than my dad had. And I listened to Charlie Parker and I listened to John Coltrane and Thelonious Monk, Duke Ellington, Billy Strayhorn, you know and started to really cultivate that music in my education.

MR: Think of some of the most memorable gigs along the way. You've mentioned Dizzy. Did you get to play with Dizzy?

HH: I got to play at a session with Dizzy, yes, in New York.

MR: When was that?

HH: Oh gosh, that was actually when I was in New York studying with Frank and Slide Hampton was nice enough to take me to a session after hours on Bleecker Street. And at that time they were finishing a rehearsal of the United Nations Band, or what later became the United Nations Band was finishing a rehearsal and I got to play with Dizzy. And then again at Moody's wedding out here, Dizzy was the best man, and Mike

Wofford and I played the wedding music. And of all things, we had to perform Con Alma, which is one of Dizzy's — shall we say — harder charts to play. And I was sitting at that wedding thinking oh my God, I've got to play Con Alma in front of Dizzy Gillespie. I was a nervous wreck. But he was just such a sweetheart.

MR: Well we were talking about James Moody before I think the cameras were rolling too. He's quite a personality. Very supportive.

HH: Very supportive. And Moody's word of mouth has gotten me a lot of gigs. And he's been very supportive, very helpful, and as I was mentioning, he often calls me up and plays a lick over the phone for me, you know, not so much a lick but a pattern, some interesting pattern with lots of complicated intervals.

MR: He sang a few for us on camera. Here, how about this one? [scats]. Well it's interesting, he — we shouldn't be talking about him — but he did say that he mostly learned by ear, it wasn't until later on that he applied chordal knowledge to what he was already doing. Does that apply at all to how you learned? Or were you learning the theory of improvising along the way?

HH: No, my dad didn't know that. He was an ear player. He knew the chord changes to the tunes, but he didn't understand the traditional theory approach to it. He couldn't have taught that to me. He could tell me what notes were in the chord, but he didn't know how to label it. So I didn't learn that until I was in high school, well I had basic theory classes as a young child, but really it wasn't until I got in to high school at Interlochen that I started learning how you spell chord changes and what they're called. So I played by ear for a long time. And interestingly enough I don't teach a whole lot because I'm on the road too much and I don't teach children because I believe they need a regular regimen. But I do have several adult students and some college students here I'm teaching for credit, and I take a totally different approach to teaching jazz from many of the other jazz teachers, and that is I teach them by ear, and I teach them the theory of it so they can go back and correct what their ear doesn't take them through. And that's what I really kind of had to go back and do. Slide was one of the main musicians who pointed out how well I played, but that I was missing maybe a change or two in every tune that my ear didn't take me through. And this was as a young person. Then I would go back and say why am I missing that and what am I hearing that's not really there, and what is that chord change. And then that made it a more technical study.

MR: Isn't it helpful to get those kind of suggestions along the way.

HH: Oh yeah. Mentors.

MR: That he was praising you and then he was also saying, and now—

HH: And very few people will do that for you. Mostly what people want to do for you is say gee you sound wonderful. Pat you on the head and say you'll be great someday, and just

send you on your way. The guys that take the time to make a suggestion without discouraging you as a young player are really the important guys.

MR: Have you been able to get involved in any of the — there are some women in jazz efforts around the country, have you been involved in those?

HH: Not too much. I prefer to play with musicians that I choose for musical reasons.

MR: There you go.

HH: But I am playing on Billy Taylor's Mary Lou Williams Jazz Festival at Kennedy Center in May. And they did ask me in this case to bring a female band. So I'm taking some wonderful female musicians. It's such a good festival that I made the exception there because I think it's promoting women in the right way, and I think it's all about the serious women jazz artists. But I do try to stay away from that as much as I can. I do play with some female players, but they would be because I choose them, not necessarily because I want to put a whole band together of women.

MR: Right. Because they're good at what they do.

HH: Yeah.

MR: Marian McPartland I think has been involved in some of those things. Have you ever gotten to meet her?

HH: Yes. We worked together, as a matter of fact we put on a women's seminar for young women at the IAJE conference last year in Chicago. And it was the professional women doing a seminar and concert for the young women, the students, both high school and college that were there. So Marian and I played on that concert for them, and talked to them and did a little mini clinic. She was wonderful. She moved so slowly to the piano, I was worried that maybe she was not feeling well or feeling tired or whatever. When she sat down she just blew everyone away.

MR: You have pretty wide ranging tastes in music I think, by listening to your CDs. There's still some classical elements you throw in there. And I'm not sure I have this — maybe I should just start over on this one. I wanted to play the very beginning of this one tune because I thought it was pretty neat.

[audio interlude]

MR: Actually, Hubert Laws sounds like he listens to you.

HH: Don't tell him that.

MR: You have a great lower register too. Now is this fairly spontaneous?

HH: This is all improvised.

MR: This is all improvised.

HH: Well you know fugal music, classical fugal music is very similar to jazz. When one has a figured bass, one can improvise over a figured bass. And actually the way Bill Cunliffe and I have started our long — when we started our long musical association, and in fact

we're recording another album in May together, I heard Bill in the years when I was booking the Hilton Grand here in San Diego. I heard Bill throw in a classical fugal section in the middle of a jazz tune one night, when he wasn't even playing for me, it was with the Clayton Brothers. And I went, oh, oh there is somebody else that does it. I went running over to the piano and I said Bill would you like to come down and play with me? And he said well sure. I was so excited and it has become such a wonderful musical association, the duo — in our reviews they always say it's like glue, it's just seamless, because we both are classically trained, we both feel the same kind of interplay between classical and jazz at times, and there's just something there, I think because of all that background that's similar.

MR: And a touch of new age in one of your records, too.

HH: Well I think there's a place for that. I think a well written new age tune, unfortunately not much of the new age material is well written musically, and I think that that taints new age. In fact so many people were horrified as you probably read in the liner notes, but I said I actually put a new age tune on my new CD with Bill. But it's a well written composition first and foremost. And I wanted everyone to see that that is possible, and I wanted to have something with synth on it — synthesizer — and a little bit of percussion, just for something different for the listeners.

MR: The new age and some of the fusion music seems to abandon hip chord changes. And that's too bad.

HH: That's really a good way of putting it.

MR: Why does it have to abandon them?

HH: I don't know.

MR: Joe Zawinul wrote plenty of great stuff.

HH: It doesn't have to. There are good writers in that idiom. There are some great Sting tunes.

MR: Yeah.

HH: You know pop music doesn't have to abandon chordal integrity, but then on the other hand there is a certainly a market for mindless music, you know? There's a market for background music where one doesn't have to or even want to listen to any kind of infrastructure or involvement there. They want it really to be a groove, or a melody that doesn't give them any kind of — they don't feel they have to be listening. It's there.

MR: It's easy to ignore.

HH: There's a huge market for that.

MR: Do you think technology, especially with synthesizers and drum machines and the way music is recorded, has any effect on that?

HH: I think that's all about dollars and cents unfortunately. Unfortunately we've become a nation, even in our arts, of the money-making process preceding the art form. And so drum machines are cheaper than a drummer.

MR: I think there's a danger too like with composers if you have a gorgeous reverb drenched sound on a keyboard and you hit it and it sounds so luscious by itself, that you're tempted not to go anywhere with it. That you end up just writing this thing.

HH: And there's a lot of that out there.

MR: Well can you recall one of the worst gigs you ever played?

HH: Oh gee, no one's ever asked me that in an interview.

MR: I should have had you thinking about it. Because I think we tend to not want to think of those.

HH: It would be a toss up between, and it wasn't an actual gig. I was being brought in to sit in with players in New York City my first year in New York, by Slide, who decided to involve me in a cutting session. That was my worst performing nightmare. My worst gig was when a rhythm section stopped playing in the middle of one of my tunes in Australia, no it was New Zealand. I had a student rhythm section, all music students, and they were supposed to be pretty good and we had a rehearsal that afternoon and they were very intimidated by playing with an American artist, and their nerves just got the best of them, and they just fell apart in the middle of a tune and just stopped. And there's just no way to — so I turned around and looked at them, and I said, "well that wasn't the ending we were planning folks, but—"

MR: There you go.

HH: There you go and we're going to go on to the next tune now. And I just had a feeling in my chest that was just — get me through this gig.

MR: Was this a concert situation?

HH: This was a very big concert situation. This was many, many people. So it'd be a toss up. The cutting session was a nightmare of its own though.

MR: Well if you don't mind, tell me about that. Because I've often wondered what that would be like — I've never been in I think a real cutting session like that. Was it the tunes they called?

HH: It was the tunes and the tempos.

MR: The tunes and the tempos.

HH: It was a very famous group in New York City who were quite appalled that Slide brought this little flute player in to sit in with them, and they just decided that they were going to see if I could play. Thank God my dad had given me a list of cutting session tunes, like "Cherokee," and you know the ones that they really do it to you on. And they called

"Cherokee," and it's one-one-one-one. It's so fast that they can't play it, but it doesn't matter because they want to see if you can play it.

MR: Put you on the spot.

HH: Right. And then the saxophone player who shall remain nameless came over and said "well honey, do you think you can play "Just Friends?" And I said, "yes I can." He says, "okay, B major, one-two, one-two-three-four."

MR: Get out. He did that?

HH: Yeah. And Slide went over and said, "guys, you know, don't do this, because it's making you look bad." And Slide just said — you will stay — I wanted to get off the stage and he said, "you will stand there and you will play because this is the tradition. This is what's been done. This is what Diz did to Miles. This is what has been done to people over the years as long as jazz has been an art form." So he said just to stay with it and do it, and to do the best you can, and I did okay. And you know, "Just Friends" in B major is a real trip. But thank God I was playing by ear.

MR: Yeah. Thank God you got started when you were five with your father doing that.

HH: And they just kept calling tunes at that tempo. "Cherokee," "Hot House," it just didn't stop for the rest of the set.

MR: And this was in a club atmosphere?

HH: Yeah. So I guess those two would tie right in there for the worst musical experiences. What's worse? "Just Friends" in B major, or a rhythm section stopping in the middle of a tune? I don't know.

MR: Did you continue to play when that happened for while, hoping that maybe they just would find where they were?

HH: I kind of just did a cadenza, and realized by the looks on their faces that they were not going to come back in, and just kind of ended the tune. And the audience was very amused. I mean they knew what had happened and they were very sweet. I had very little wherewithal to gather my wits about me to start the next tune, I was just —

MR: Well the hazards of going to unknown venues I guess. You said you've played in Australia.

HH: And New Zealand is a wonderful country, and wonderful people and they love jazz and they can't wait to get your CDs, and there's really a wonderful audience there. And the jazz societies are very active. But these were younger players that needed a little more work.

MR: Were they mortified afterwards?

HH: I think they were, yeah. Pretty upset.

MR: Have you invested in a major flute over these years? Do you play a very expensive instrument may I ask?

HH: Well I have a Haynes that was designed for me by Maurice Sharp that's now a collector's item and I feel a little uncomfortable taking it on the road, and so for the road I use a Pearl, which is a lesser expensive, it's actually kind of a mid-range model flute and I have a headjoint on it that was made for me by a headjoint designer in Australia, who made it for me while I was there. And so it adds just that little extra umph to a standard model pro flute that I need. That's pretty much what I play and I love that headjoint because it cuts through the rhythm section and I don't really have to play highly amplified, which I like to keep the flute in its natural — I worked a long time on that sound, and I don't want it to sound amplified.

MR: That's true. You could be at the mercy of some sound man that way.

HH: And you're always at the mercy of sound men. Thank God I have a good one here.

MR: Do you ever get really aggravated at people on gigs?

HH: Yes. Because sound men very often are not jazz sound men, and they don't really understand that jazz is not a highly amplified music. And they want a lot of reverb on the flute. Reverb and flute seem to be a thing for them. And I keep saying one number of reverb, and pretty soon I'm in the wa-wa-wa-wa—

MR: You're in the Taj Mahal. Well is there anything I haven't asked you that I should?

HH: Boy, I think you've covered so many topics. There's an art to interviewing, you've covered it.

MR: Where is your next trip?

HH: My next trip is to the State of Washington for the Semi Annual Jazz Party. It used to be, it kind of was a descendent of the Otter Crest, the famous Otter Crest Jazz Party that went on for years and years. And that's the first week of March.

MR: When I look at some of these festivals, I notice, unfortunately the audience seems to be over 55, and white, and I'm hoping that would change but I don't know if it will.

HH: I think jazz parties that is the case. That seems to be the demographic that has the money and the interest in going to the jazz parties. The festivals I see are starting to change. Younger people are getting involved in the festivals, there certainly is a wide range of ethnic groups and age groups now, more and more. And of course jazz festivals have had to incorporate some of the younger musicians and also the more contemporary so-called jazz artists, to draw that element in, but I don't know if it's such a bad thing. Jazz is presented — there's a lot of styles of jazz, and things that are called jazz that aren't really, but somehow getting the young, you know we all look at that. My band looks at that a lot of times, at our audience. And we're very fortunate because we have a lot of young listeners here in San Diego that come to the Sheraton to hear us play, and we're thrilled about that, because the music has to be passed down. I sometimes wonder if I'm

going to have enough audience when I'm Moody's age, you know? When I'm in my 70s, I want somebody to still listen to the music.

MR: How does that happen? Am I correct in hearing that California has very little music in the schools anymore?

HH: I think there's a lot of states that don't have a lot of music. California doesn't have much. I think there are though, in every state, and as I go to a place like IAJE's convention, I realize there are the individuals and the programs that still have band programs that the kids are learning so much and responding to. And I think it's just a matter of those individuals that keep those programs going, keeping them going, trying to expand them, until art becomes, the arts become in again. San Diego is not a very — we have lost our symphony for some time, they'll be going back to work here soon. So I think California needs to work harder at supporting their arts, for sure.

MR: Do you ever get calls to do any classical work anymore?

HH: Yeah. I still get to play as a sub, with quite a number of chamber groups. So that's good, it keeps my hand in it. I get very nervous about it, because I have to remember that I'm playing the articulation on Mozart and not Stravinsky. That's not in my brain anymore after college.

MR: Don't swing this one. Yeah that's got to be a different mindset. I've found it to be the most nerve wracking to play, well my last experience playing saxophone in an orchestra, it just was a piece where there was five minutes of rest at a time, which was the really hard part I think, just concentrating so much.

HH: Counting, yeah. You know I started to write in cues for myself at that point, you know, trumpets enter at bar 104 with this line, because it's very nerve wracking to count and have to make an entrance, an entrance all by yourself.

MR: Yeah. And hope the conductor knows where you are too. Do you write music at a keyboard?

HH: I don't own a piano so generally speaking I write it with my flute, I run the changes, and then I sit at a keyboard at some point when I'm starting to get it put together and play the changes to make sure that's what I want.

MR: So you play the changes on your flute, up and down, and you can hear if that's in the ballpark of what you want.

HH: In the ballpark, and then it takes me actually doing it at the piano to make sure that I'm right and I sometimes don't have quite the right voicing or the right changes, but I at least have an idea of what gender of chord I want there. I've been looking at keyboards and things, I just hate the sound of them, the little portable keyboards. I probably need to get one of those.

MR: Well this has been a pleasure to talk to you. I know you've done a little promoting around the area and that you're pretty well known in the San Diego area. Do you think you'll be doing any more to promote your festival here, the one you're involved in at any rate, you have something coming up in Irvine?

HH: Every year at the Labor Day Weekend, and the roster just came out in the press today, so it's a wonderful jazz party, it's one of the only mainstream jazz parties.

MR: Don't they do one at the same time in Los Angeles? The Classic Jazz?

HH: Yes. That's a traditional trad jazz festival. And there's also a wonderful festival at Vail at the same time. It's more of an educational effort.

MR: Nick Brignola.

HH: Yeah, wonderful.

MR: I know Nick, he lives just a couple of hours from us, and he said to say hello to you, as a matter of fact I remember now, I told him we were coming out here, and I think he said that he may be playing with you. Maybe that's what he was referring to.

HH: Yeah. What a fun guy to play with. Flute — and everybody says flute and bari — oh. And just like when Slide and I used to perform together — flute and trombone — oh, what's that going to sound like? It sounds wonderful. Opposite ends of the tonal spectrum.

MR: Well I wish you a lot of luck. I hope no one calls any tunes in the key of B for you.

HH: Me too.

MR: Unless it's you. That's makes for a great story though see? Now you've had a chance to tell it on camera. I'm sure you were thinking that at the time.

HH: That it would go down in the archives of my life. Some day I'll need that story.

MR: Well at least no one threw a cymbal across the floor at you. I think that's what the famous scene from the Charlie Parker, that someone threw a cymbal because he wasn't cutting it. Well listen, best of luck to you in your travels.

HH: It's been fun talking to you.

MR: All right. Thanks so much.